ACTION PLAN FOR A NEW ENTREPRENEUR EXPORTER

Phase 1: Business Setup & Market Research

✅ Step 1: Business Registration & Compliance

- Register the company (e.g., Private Limited, LLP, partnership or Proprietorship).
- Obtain Import Export Code (IEC) from DGFT.
- Register for GST, MSME, AD code, Port registration and other applicable licenses.
- Open a current bank account with an international transaction facility.

✅ Step 2: Market Research & Product Selection

- Identify profitable export products based on demand and availability.
- Analize target markets (Country wise).
- Study competitors, pricing, and regulatory requirements.

✅ Step 3: Business & Marketing Strategy

- Build a website & digital presence (social media, B2B platforms)
- Develop a catalogue, brochures, and pricing sheet.
- Create an export business plan (including costing, profit margins, and logistics).

Phase 2: Sourcing & Documentation

✅ Step 4: Supplier & Quality Management

- Identify reliable suppliers and negotiate best quality & pricing.
- Establish a quality control & inspection process.

✅ Step 5: Export Documentation & Compliance

- Register with Export Promotion Councils (like APEDA, FIEO, etc.).
- Learn about country-specific regulations, certifications, and labelling.
- Arrange or know about necessary documents:
- Proforma Invoice & Commercial Invoice
- Packing List
- Bill of Lading (BL) / Airway Bill (AWB)
- Certificate of Origin
- Insurance Certificate

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Phase 3: Finding Buyers & Securing Orders

✅ Step 6: Lead Generation & Business Development

- Approach potential buyers via LinkedIn, trade fairs, and business directories.
- Register on B2B platforms.
- Participate in export promotion events & buyer-seller meets.
- Connect with export agents & trade associations.

✅ Step 7: Negotiation & Order Confirmation

- Send samples and pricing proposals to interested buyers.
- Negotiate payment terms (LC, Advance, DA/DP).
- Finalize the contract & agreement with the buyer.

Phase 4: Logistics & Shipment Execution

✅ Step 8: Logistics & Freight Booking

- Choose the best freight forwarder for shipping (Sea/Air).
- Confirm INCOTERMS (FOB, CNF, CIF, EXW, etc.).
- Arrange custom clearance & export duty payments.
- Book a container or air cargo space.

✅ Step 9: Pre-Shipment & Export Compliance

- Conduct third-party inspection (SGS, Bureau Veritas, etc.) if required.
- Obtain phytosanitary, health, or other certificates as per import country regulations.
- Pack and label products as per international shipping standards.
- Get export insurance for cargo safety.
- Get ECGC cover for Payment Safety

✅ Step 10: Post-Shipment & Payment Collection

- Send shipment tracking details to the buyer.
- Submit necessary documents to the bank for LC or DA/DP payment processing.
- Ensure payment collection within agreed timelines.

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Phase 5: Growth & Expansion

✅ Step 11: Customer Feedback & Relationship Management

- Follow up with the buyer for feedback & future orders.
- Offer value-added services like customized packaging, bulk discounts, etc.

✅ Step 12: Business Expansion & Diversification

- Explore new markets and expand product range.
- Build long-term partnerships with buyers and distributors.
- Invest in digital marketing, SEO, and branding for better visibility.
- Scale operations with better sourcing, warehouse, and logistics optimization.

Your One-Stop Export Solution Partner

With its end-to-end solutions, GFE eliminates the challenges of starting and running an export business. From training to finding buyers, from compliance to logistics, GFE ensures exporters focus on growth while minimizing risks.

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